

Working title

The title will be the reader's first indication of what it is you set out to do, and the contents will be judged on how well they relate to it. The title should not be too long, but should focus the reader's mind on the main problem or issue. Your title might change over time, but it is important that the final title truly reflects the content of the written report.

Main issue or problem

The reasons for undertaking the project should be briefly stated and the specific issues and/or problems should be carefully and clearly defined.

Aims and objectives

The general aims and more specific objectives should be stated. It is important to give careful thought to this, because the final outcome of the project will be judged against the original aims and objectives.

General approach

This will obviously be tentative initially, and should include suggested stages of investigation, methodologies, models to be tested, type of data to be considered, as well as methods of collection and analysis. Key references should be included.

Provisional time schedule

Important milestones should be clearly indicated, as well as items that require a significant time span such as identifying, obtaining and reviewing information, acquiring skills (if applicable), piloting questionnaires. This is so that appropriate allowance can be made. Drawing up a simple [Gantt chart](#) is often useful and necessary for your first assignment.

Suggested chapter headings

It is unlikely that final decisions can be made at this stage. It is, however, important to have an indication of the likely overall 'shape' of the project report and to ascertain that it follows logically from the objectives. In the

next module, there are recommendations available for a typical set of chapters that can be used as a template.

Values of the project

Considering this aspect and stating it clearly at the beginning will assist in obtaining support and help for the project should you require it. Where necessary, it should help to 'sell' the project to powerful stakeholders.